

**Regular Meeting
Monday, December 9, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford City Hall**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, Student Representative Marc Alenn Jean-Mary.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:14pm.

Approval of the Minutes of November 18, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committee - Rules Subcommittee 11.18.19 Minutes for Approval - Mr. Ruseau - a note that we do not think it necessary to reprint handbooks midyear. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Last week we had our first snow day. Special thanks to DPW and our custodians for clearing roadways and sidewalks so our students could make it to school on Wednesday. Special thanks to Bill and Sue Honeycutt, who graciously hosted the 8th Annual Pre-Thanksgiving Luncheon at John Brewers Tavern, and thanks to Lisa Kingsley for hosting the Annual Thanksgiving luncheon at the Curtis Tufts High School. The annual Thanksgiving Pep Rally energized the students and faculty in preparation for the Thanksgiving Football game. Special thanks to Headmaster D'Alleva and Assistant Principal Dr. Stacey Mulligan for putting together such an entertaining event. The Mustang band, step team and cheerleaders did a great job as well as all the students who participated. Our football team may not have won but good sportsmanship always wins. We thank Malden for their support of our boys soccer team.

McGlynn Middle School and Andrews Middle School 8th grade classes were honored to hear a presentation by the first ever Youth Poet Laureate of the United States of America at the

McGlynn Middle School. Amanda Gorman has been called “the next great figure of poetry in the U.S.” Amanda, currently a senior at Harvard University, recited her own award winning poetry and performed her own rap lyrics. She challenged students to put their pen to paper during the assembly and described how students could write their own poetry. What a wonderful opportunity for our students, courtesy of CCSR, the Cummings Foundation, and the Krystle Campbell Betterment Foundation.

Students from Medford High School, Medford Vocational Technical High School and the Curtis Tufts High School were energized and motivated by GirlsRising.org, a non-profit organization created to inspire young girls to be game changers, while being inclusive to all. The event opened with a rousing set from the band Antigone Rising. Kerry Kavanaugh, News Anchor/Investigative Reporter, Fox 25 News, and Medford native, served as the moderator for an outstanding group of accomplished females who graciously shared their stories of working in male dominated professions with the students. It was gratifying to see so many students stay after the presentation to try to speak to the presenters. Special thanks to Maureen Lavin, Interim Director of Guidance, and her fellow guidance counselors for the organization of this wonderfully motivating event.

1,430 canned goods were donated to needy families by McGlynn Elementary students. They collected cans and non-perishable items for families at Thanksgiving.

For the past month and a half our internet has been unreliable due to cyber security issues. We had an emergency meeting with our vendor, Addition Networks. During Thanksgiving break, we upgraded our internet and our phone lines are now fully functioning and we are working out the remaining kinks in the internet.

As part of the new PALS Program in which the Medford Public Schools work together with the Medford Police Department, Officer Franzese had lunch with Columbus Elementary students who used their PBIS coupons to receive this special privilege. The students were Ronen Appleby, Adrian DePaula and Beberly Prince. Congratulations to them for being Responsible, Respectful, and Safe.

Middle School Sports: boys and girls basketball has started again; games began last week. Mustang student athletes Aidan Barry, Osiris Wise, Alex Valera, Siobhan Paras, Rayanne Forbes and Rachell Paz, along with boys basketball coach John Skerry and girls lacrosse coach Meghan Olsen, attended the 26th Annual MIAA Sportsmanship Summit held at Gillette Stadium. The theme of the summit was: “Celebrating those who make sportsmanship a priority.” The student athletes heard from Eddie Slowikowski, a motivational speaker, who discussed how athletes can

best prepare themselves to perform at their highest ability, as well as how to live a life in service to others.

Mustang Mall will be open extended hours this Friday: 2:30pm-7pm. Medford Vocational Technical High School students are collecting canned goods for food baskets with the Medford Rotary Club. Scarves are being sold as a fundraiser for a trip to Argentina. Medford Family Network has a mitten trail. You can select a mitten off the wall and it will indicate a small gift that is needed by one of our families.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Internet upgrade: How much did that cost? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - It is all under contract. \$175,000 for the remainder of this year, and there was no additional charge.

Mr. Ruggiero - You mentioned cyber security attacks on our network, is that correct? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes. Dr. Cushing - The work was done over Thanksgiving break. There were DDOS attacks from China, Russia, and Ukraine. Addition Networks are working with us to resolve it and they have been responsive and helpful.

Mayor Burke - Welcome to our student representative tonight.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip to National Parks April 2021 - Audrey Feitor - My interest in this trip comes from wanting to do a trip that embraces the inclusiveness of America's National Parks. April is a great time to visit Arizona, not too hot or too cold. We estimate 20 or 25 students. The trip would be all-inclusive. Representative from Grand Classroom Gregg Wachtelhausen - This is step one or two of what this trip will become as we look at aligning the trip with curriculum goals. This is active adventure education, climate education, cultural experiences at Native American reservations, and it is fun but at its core this is an educational experience. Mr. Ruseau - Who do you expect to be signing up for this? Ms. Feitor - It would be open to anyone who would want to go. We felt for the first time it would be easier to go with 11th and 12th graders. I would say it would be students who are looking for something different than going on a language trip to Europe. Students who maybe always wanted to travel but were not able to leave the country. Students who are interested in environmental science and history, you can get both of those from this trip. Mr. Wachtelhausen - These trips are scalable for the groups, they are appropriate for age level and activity level. There can be additions and changes to the itinerary as needed. Ms. Van der Kloot - The trip sounds wonderful. I was surprised at how expensive it will be. Mr. Wachtelhausen - This is activity driven and not sight-seeing, and it is all-inclusive. Students will not need to bring any additional money for meals or tips. It is not a luxury travel experience. It makes it easier for teachers to not have to worry about money on the trip. Ms. Van der Kloot - I do worry it is out of reach for some of our students. Mr.

Wachtelhausen - We can set up payment plans for families since this is planned very far out.
Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

6 - Affirmative

1 - Abstain - Mr. Ruseau

Motion passes.

Report on College Fair - Maureen Lavin - The College Fair was very successful. There is also a transition fair for students with IEPs and 504s, orchestrated by Jan Hollenbeck and Charlotte Heim. We have 173 AP students taking 275 AP tests this year. PSAT scores were just released and students can retrieve them online. Marc - I would like to know about EL student accessibility to the College Fair. Ms. Lavin - I have been working with EL Director Paul Teixeira to make sure they are served by the College Fair, that is on my radar. Ms. Kreatz - When do scholarship applications come out? Ms. Lavin - The MHS Guidance website constantly updates and does email pushes, but we have links on the site that students can access. Every day there is more information for students on our website, it is constantly updated. Nearly every senior should be understanding of the process of college applications at this point. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report on Professional Development Day - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - This was the first of two all-day professional development days offered by the district. There were 39 different workshops throughout the day, some whole-day sessions and some half-day sessions. The next all-day professional development will be on March 3rd, 2020. As always, we hope to gauge the success of our offerings, so we asked attendees how we did and we had very high ratings from participants. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on Community Preservation Grants - Dr. Peter Cushing - Thank you to Kirsteen Patterson and John McLaughlin for help on this grant. The elementary schools are the newest school buildings but they are still nearing 20 years old. We are looking for architectural design firms and engineering firms to come on site and look at the playgrounds. We are addressing accessibility, environmental impact, blending with the environment, and ability of students to engage and play. Mayor Burke - Have you consulted with procurement? Dr. Cushing - Not at the city side. Mayor Burke - I suggest you do. Ms. Van der Kloot - What are other alternatives to rubberized surfaces? Wood chips? Dr. Cushing - With the other schools being smaller, it is about fall zones. Since the McGlynn is larger, we think we can reduce the square footage number to be smaller. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thanks to Cheryl Rodriguez who brought this to us initially. Mr. Ruseau - An accessible playground is not a regular playground. I bet our regular playgrounds are not accessible. The cost to make all the playgrounds accessible would be prohibitive I fear. Ms. Kreatz - I would like to hear the plan for solving the drainage issue. Ms. McLaughlin - What is

the experience of the architects with accessible playgrounds? Dr. Cushing - They brought it up and had experience. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

New Business

1. A report of classes taught in K-12 by non-certified teachers, including online courses, as a normal matter of course, should be provided to this committee no later than our February 24 meeting. Ms. Van der Kloot - I was puzzled when I received this. I think this should be a resolution offered by a school committee member and identify who offered it. Resolution offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, resolution passes.
2. Votes will no longer be taken to accept or to approve reports presented to this committee except as required by law. Votes to “place on file” may continue to be taken. Motion to send to Rules Subcommittee offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.
3. All motions to be offered must be written down by the member prior to being offered. Ms. DiBenedetto - I find the flow of information brings up issues and opportunities and if we limit opportunities we might lose the flow and the input and this rule could inhibit the process. That is something I like about it, that we can add to it and work on it together as a fluid thing. If it is too rigid ideas can be lost. Motion to send to the Rules Subcommittee offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.
4. All amendments to motions should be written down, motion to send to the Rules Subcommittee offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.
5. The Superintendent’s office shall compile a complete set of rules of this committee, as best can be discerned from the available record, to be presented to the Chair of the Rules Subcommittee no later than the meeting on June 15, 2020. There is no requirement that this compilation be formatted. Motion to send to the Rules Subcommittee offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Mayor Burke read condolences for Janet E. Sands, Clarette Kountze, and Kim Dervishian.

Motion to enter executive session offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Entered executive session at 8:14pm.

Exit executive session at 9:12pm.

Meeting adjourned at 9:12pm.